MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 6/17/2026 IW

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Un~~approved minutes
May 20, 2026

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling (arrived late), District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis

OTHERS PRESENT

Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the agenda as presented with the addition, **Motion carried.**

*Addition: XII. Finance and Administration d. Deficit Elimination Plan

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of April 15, 2026, **Motion carried**.

It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the Board of Commissioners Special Meeting Minutes of May 5, 2026, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

Dewayne Rogers, Clare County Road Commissioner Manager, stated that he brought in the Road Commission's Spring Newsletter for everyone to read. He expressed his gratitude for Jerry Becker, Director of the Clare County Emergency Services Homeland Security Division, for his help during the recent flooding. Additionally, Dewayne Rogers reported that the Road Commission's construction season is underway with paving, culvert replacement and gravel road projects.

A Hayes Township resident shared concern that the video recordings of previous meetings are difficult to watch. He mentioned that people's faces are cut off, the audio is hard to hear and the camera does not follow faces.

A member of the public asked in general what criteria determines whether an issue goes to a people vote versus a planning commission. The response was to fill out a form and a written response will be given.

A Hayes Township resident sited a few instances in previous meetings where it appears the Commissioners have a lack of time to prepare so they are fully informed on issues they will vote on. He suggested the Board of Commissioners return to having the Committee of the Whole meetings or have two regular meetings a month in order to better prepare.

Several Clare County residents expressed their opposition to the proposed recycling transfer station in Hayes Township. They requested that the Board of Commissioners withdraw their support.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Letter from ITC Holdings Corporation – No discussion
2. Notification of Master Plan update – Village of Farwell – No discussion
3. Citizens Letters to Board: Timothy York, Amanda Bell, Kimberly Shepherd – No discussion
4. MMR Report through April 2026 – No discussion
5. Resolution regarding Michigan Drain Code, Mecosta County – No discussion
6. Audit Letter to State from Lori Phelps and Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger – No discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps provided the Commissioners with legislative and financial updates from the State. She reported on several House bills regarding housing development, planning infrastructure and public safety decisions. The initial on-boarding meeting with BS&A took place last week; the projection date to go live is December 7, 2026. Administrator Phelps stated that the State has rolled out the public safety revenue sharing program for cities, villages and townships.

She reported that work continues on the County's Materials Management Plan. She recently sent survey requests to the Clare County Cleaver, Clare County elected officials and posted it on the Clare County website. It is important that Clare County residents participate and complete the survey before the end of the month. Lastly, Administrator Phelps stated that she completed the Deficit Elimination Plan for the Michigan Indigent Defense Fund but recently discovered that she needs to submit it with a resolution, which is why there is an addition to the agenda today.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

None

JUSTICE

1. Community Corrections
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Resolution #26-10 to apply for grant funding for the continuation of the Community Corrections Program, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Ambrozaitis
   Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Brownfield Authority
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to appoint the same members of the Land Bank Authority to serve on the Brownfield Authority, **Motion carried**.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of April 13, 2026 in the amount of $70,478.30 and the meeting minutes of April 27, 2026 in the amount of $148,445.17 and the meeting minutes of May 11, 2026 in the amount of $143,071.33, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Fancon, Gilmore, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Ambrozaitis
   Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the expenditures for the month of April 2026, in the amount of $1,762,757.01 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,271,353.06, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Haskell, Majewski, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Gross, Gilmore, Hoefling and Housler
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Ambrozaitis
   Motion carried.

3. Budget Adjustments - None

4. Deficit Elimination Plan
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to approve Resolution #26-11 approving the Deficit Elimination Plan for the Michigan Indigent Defense Fund Deficit for Fiscal Year ended September 30, 2025, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Gilmore, Hoefling, Majewski, Housler, Fancon, Haskell and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Ambrozaitis
   Motion carried.

SHERIFF'S REPORT

Sheriff John Wilson presented the Board of Commissioners with a year-to-date report. His report included information from the City of Clare Police Department, the Clare County Animal Shelter, Fire and Rescue and other departments. Sheriff Wilson mentioned that the Clare County Dispatch is currently understaffed, however the road patrol is fully staffed. He went into detail with other staffing arrangements and equipment upgrades. Lastly, Sheriff Wilson reported that construction for the sally port is scheduled to begin in July.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioner on their desks.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore has attended his meetings. He stated that Grant Township was pleased to learn that Clare County decided to go with BS&A Cloud.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon asked if there is county-wide support for Clare County homeless residents. Administrator Phelps gave the phone number for Mid-Michigan Community Action.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings. She announced that Garfield Township is hosting a car wash on Saturday, May 23, 2026.

Commissioner Hoefling gave a reminder that the grand opening for Hamilton Township's park will be June 6, 2026. The ribbon cutting ceremony begins at 11:30 a.m. and food will be served from 12:00 p.m. until 4:00 p.m. He also mentioned that several of his townships continue to voice their opposition to data centers.

Commissioner Majewski has attended his meetings. He announced that the Lincoln Township Fire Department is hosting a pancake breakfast fundraiser on Saturday, May 23, 2026 from 9:00 a.m. until 12:00 p.m.

Commissioner Gross had nothing to report.

Commissioner Haskell had nothing to report.

Commissioner Kleinhardt asked if an explanation could be provided on how the Materials Management Planning Committee needs to come up with a plan for recycling due to the possibility of Lansing eliminating the Michigan Bottle Bill. Administrator Phelps responded that she can put together a summary of the information currently gathered and present it at the next meeting. Commissioner Kleinhardt emphasized that the recycling center is not a done deal.

PUBLIC COMMENT

Clare County residents reiterated their opinions against the proposed recycling transfer station.

A member of the public expressed an opinion that the Board of Commissioners' meetings need to be moved to the afternoon. He also stated that Commissioner Fancon has made statements at previous meetings that if the majority of the people did not want it, he would have it stopped. He encouraged people to complete the survey on the Clare County website as Administrator Phelps asked.

A Hayes Township resident asked if the phone number to Mid-Michigan Community Action could be distributed to the townships to put on their websites. He added that he believes that the Board of Commissioners will do what is right for the community.

A member of the public expressed concern regarding the new parks in the area. She questioned whether or not the maintenance of the parks will be funded through taxpayers' funds, even though the parks were built with grant funds.

A Clare County resident clarified the rules the County Board of Commissioners should follow in the event a change needs to be made to the Board of County Road Commissioners. He also explained the difference between Committee of the Whole meetings and Regular meetings. Lastly, he noted that during the March 18, 2026 meeting members of the public were given more than the allotted three minutes to speak and he hopes that the Board continues to keep to the three minutes in the future.

Commissioner Hoefling stated that he agrees with the return of the Committee of the Whole meetings.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

ADJOURNMENT

It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Housler to adjourn, **Motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 9:59 a.m.

Isha Walter, Deputy Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners